

Give every agent clear title to act.

ACTUAL MANDATE

Translate emerging AI capability into trustworthy, intuitive mortgage-workflow experiences that improve speed and service while keeping evidence, human authority, exception handling and recovery visible.

COMPANY MOMENT

ServiceLink publicly positions EXOS as an end-to-end technology platform for title, closing, valuation, flood and default services. Its 2026 messaging emphasizes borrower speed, transparency, flexibility and continued human guidance. Agentic workflows will increase the need for consistent behavior across channels and decision boundaries.

Candidate Thesis

An AI action should not “close” until the product establishes clear title to act: the user intent is understood, the material evidence is visible, the agent’s authority is explicit, exceptions are detected, recovery is designed and a usable decision receipt remains.

CENTRAL OPERATING TENSIONS

Tension	Design implication
Autonomous speed vs. human accountability	Design bounded action states, explicit approval points and evidence-rich handoffs.
Customized lender workflows vs. consistent agent behavior	Create reusable behavior patterns with configurable policy, channel and exception layers.
Multichannel convenience vs. one coherent record	Preserve intent, promises, evidence and escalation context across workflow UI, chat, SMS and voice.
Personalization vs. privacy, compliance and fairness	Make context use visible, proportional and reviewable; distinguish support from advice or consequential judgment.

DECISION ARCHITECTURE

The role should make it easier to decide: when the agent may act; when it may only recommend; which evidence must be shown; what qualifies as an exception; who retains final authority; what the recovery path is; how behavior is evaluated; and which patterns are ready for reuse.

STAKEHOLDER TOPOLOGY

Group	What the design must make easier
Borrowers and end users	Understand status, evidence, choices, commitments, handoffs and how to recover when the workflow is wrong.
Operations and service teams	See exception context, ownership, urgency and the smallest safe intervention without reconstructing the case.
Product, design, engineering and data science	Agree on behavior, evaluation cases, reusable patterns, instrumentation and release boundaries.
Lender, legal, compliance and risk stakeholders	Configure policy without hiding it; inspect consequential behavior and preserve accountable human authority.

CHANGE BURDEN

Teams will need to design and review agent behavior as a cross-functional product surface, not as prompt text owned by one function. Operators will need a consistent intervention model, and product teams will need to treat exceptions, recovery and decision receipts as first-class experience requirements.

Cost of leaving the tension unresolved

Faster automation can still produce slower exception work when authority, evidence and recovery are unclear. The likely consequence is not only user friction; it is repeated reconstruction, inconsistent handoffs, weak adoption and lost learning about which behavior is actually safe to reuse.

Clear Title to Act

Control	Design question	Evidence in the interface
Intent	What outcome is the user actually pursuing?	Clarification, transaction state, urgency, missing context and confirmation.
Evidence	What facts support the action?	Source, freshness, material conflicts, confidence and traceable rationale.
Authority	What may the agent decide, recommend or never do?	Visible action posture, approval gate, reversible scope and named human owner.
Encumbrance	What condition changes the rules?	Identity ambiguity, document conflict, regulated change, distress, dispute or unusual risk.
Recovery	How does the workflow return to a good state?	Clarification, alternatives, warm transfer, reversal, preserved context and resume point.
Receipt	What must remain understandable after the action?	Action, evidence, authority, exception, human decision, next step and learning signal.

ILLUSTRATIVE SCENARIO POSTURES

Appraisal scheduling - Clear to act within bounded authority.

The agent can coordinate calendars, confirm preferences and notify participants when identity, availability and escalation rules are explicit.

Closing disclosure - Controlled assist.

The agent can reconcile data, prepare a draft and explain revisions; human release authority remains visible when the commitment changes.

Title exception - Human review before action.

The agent may assemble evidence and recommend the next step, but legal or ownership ambiguity remains an encumbrance.

Borrower inquiry - Clarify or warm-transfer.

The design should distinguish status and education from advice, dispute or hardship, while preserving the conversation context.

BALANCED SUCCESS MEASURES

Dimension	Signals to establish with ServiceLink
Workflow	Cycle time, touches, rework, handoff delay, exception resolution and completion.
User	Task success, comprehension, confidence, effort, abandonment and recovery success.
Trust / risk	Authority violations, unsupported actions, missing evidence, escalation quality and reversible recovery.
Adoption	Use in target workflow, override pattern, repeat use, frontline feedback and workarounds.
Learning	Time from observed failure to updated pattern, policy or evaluation case.

Why the evidence transfers

Role need	Verified adjacent evidence
Agentic and human-oversight design	DudeWorth: direct development of structured-context, retrieval, agent, human-judgment, escalation, evaluation and governance patterns.
Complex workflow and exception mapping	Vape-Jet: direct operating work across production, quality, support, engineering issue flow, ERP/Odoo, Jira, telemetry and AI-assisted workflows.
High-consequence controls	Compunetics and ZeusVu: quality systems, process controls, chain-of-custody concepts and regulated operations.
Customer-backward operating mechanisms	Amazon: launch, standard work, escalation paths and throughput visibility in a 24/7 environment supporting approximately five million second-day orders annually.
Cross-functional facilitation	Repeated leadership and hands-on liaison work across business, engineering, operations, quality, vendors and customers.

STRONGEST REASONABLE OBJECTION

Concern: Russell has not held a conventional Senior Product Designer title in mortgage technology.

Response: Do not treat leadership titles or adjacent domain work as automatic equivalence. Evaluate the direct work shown: workflow models, AI behavior and oversight logic, prototyping, facilitation, exception and recovery design, data-informed operating mechanisms, and the quality of the role-specific artifact. The gap is real; the transferability case is testable.

FIRST 90 DAYS

Window	Focus	Concrete output
Days 0-30	Learn the product, users, workflows, constraints, design system, data and decision rights.	Workflow-and-exception atlas, stakeholder map, baseline evidence plan and prioritized design questions.
Days 31-60	Prototype one consequential workflow and its human oversight, handoff and recovery states.	Testable interaction model, agent behavior specification, evaluation cases and measurement plan.
Days 61-90	Validate with users and operators; convert learning into a reusable pattern and delivery agreement.	Pilot-ready design, trust-receipt pattern, evidence review, design-to-development package and next-wave recommendation.

EXECUTIVE INTERVIEW QUESTIONS

- Which workflows combine the highest user friction, exception cost and strategic value - and which are deliberately not automation targets?
 - Where do users currently lose confidence in automated recommendations: evidence, status, handoff, recovery or unclear ownership?
 - How do design, product, data science, engineering, operations, legal and compliance resolve disagreements about agent authority?
 - What would make a first AI design pattern reusable across EXOS rather than a one-off feature?
 - How will success balance cycle time, borrower experience, operating economics, quality, risk, adoption and learning speed?

PUBLIC SOURCES

ServiceLink homepage; About ServiceLink; Lenders overview; Title, Closing and Valuation product pages; "The Psychology of Today's Homebuyer: Rethinking the Borrower Experience in 2026"; "Q&A: A more transparent approach to scheduling." Job description supplied in chat; no public posting URL verified.